

T U M O G Y

At the most basic level, all the processes that make up what we call life come down to biochemistry—chemical interactions between a variety of complex molecules. Perhaps it should not be surprising, then, to learn that quantum effects have a part to play. Many pioneers in the field, including Erwin Schrödinger and Niels Bohr, predicted that quantum phenomena would play important roles in processes ranging from the harvesting of energy to genetic mutation, but it is only in the past few decades that our understanding of biochemistry has been able to reveal some of the details.